



JACQUES MCDERMID HEYNS

*Writing Centre Manager / Technology Literacy
Specialist / Academic Integrity Specialist*

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Location: Sasolburg, Freestate, South Africa

Professional sites/links:

[ORCID](#) | [GitHub](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Experienced higher education professional with extensive experience in academic integrity, university leadership, writing centre management, AI governance, computational linguistics and educational technology. Recognised for developing institutional initiatives, leading multidisciplinary teams and improving academic quality. Passionate about student success, ethical AI adoption and continuous innovation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

North-West University | Co-ordinator / Manager (Permanent)

2024 - Current | Vanderbijlpark, Gauteng

- Conduct technical investigations of alleged plagiarism and academic malpractice (including AI misuse), drafting detailed reports.
- Design and deliver Short Learning Programmes focused on Academic Integrity and Turnitin workshops for academic staff.
- Train writing centre consultants and advise faculty members on academic integrity policy development.
- Develop and manage an online interactive platform for identifying and intervening in academic misconduct.
- Manage day-to-day operations of the NWU Writing Centre, overseeing finances, quality control, and the online writing laboratory.
- Collaborate with Academic Literacy to support first-year students with academic writing.

North-West University | Academic Administrator / Co-ordinator

2012 - 2023 | Vanderbijlpark, Gauteng

- Managed the IT component of the Academic Literacy first-year course (ALDE 121).
- Managed and provided consultations in the NWU Writing Centre.
- Taught IT-specific ALDE 111 & 121 courses and computer skills for second-year Language Practice (LPRA 221) students.

Yeondong Elementary School | ESL Teacher

2010 - 2011 | South Korea, Yongi-Do Province

- Co-taught morning English classes alongside Korean teachers to elementary children.
- Independently taught afternoon classes and informal after-hours English classes for adult teachers.

Elite Gaming World (EGW) | Co-owner

2010 - 2011 | Centurion, Gauteng

- Managed website maintenance, sales, advertising, and customer support for a computer and console product company.
- Organised LAN gaming events and conducted network setup and maintenance.

North-West University | Sleutelbord Assistant

2008 - 2009 | Potchefstroom, North West

- Managed Internet Café operations (2009), handling financial income, delegating tasks, and providing customer service.
- Assisted students with computer needs and managed printer/laboratory hardware maintenance in the library (2008).

CText | Computational Linguist Assistant

2005 - 2007 | Potchefstroom, North West

- Performed translation, data processing, and programming in a full-time capacity (2006-2007).
- Contributed to the localisation of Windows into Afrikaans and the development of the Afrikaans Spell Checker.
- Provided after-sales customer service and offered after-hours academic guidance to 1st and 2nd-year students.

EDUCATION

North-West University | BSc Information Technology

2024 - Current | Vanderbijlpark, Gauteng

- To be completed in 2026.

North-West University | Magister Artium in Positive Psychology

2015 - 2018 | Vanderbijlpark, Gauteng

- Graduated Cum Laude.

North-West University | Psychology Subjects (Non-degree purposes)

2012 - 2014 | Vanderbijlpark, Gauteng

- Completed 1st, 2nd, and 3rd-year Psychology subjects (in two years' time) in preparation for Master's degree application.

North-West University | Baccalaureus Artium in Language Technology (Computational Linguistics)

2003 - 2007 | Potchefstroom, North West

- Graduated Cum Laude (Four-year degree equivalent to a three-year degree plus Honours).

Langenhoven Gimnasium | High School Diploma

1998 - 2002 | Oudtshoorn, Western Cape

- Maintained an A average; on the Top Ten merit list (Grade 8-12). Awarded full university exemption.

KEY STRENGTHS

- **Communication:** Excellent reading, writing, and speaking skills in both English and Afrikaans. Comfortable communicating with both superiors and staff.
- **Leadership:** Able to motivate, take initiative, and lead if required. Willing to step back, listen, and complete delegated tasks.
- **Responsibility:** Self-motivated, accustomed to responsibility, and highly goal-oriented.
- **Computer Experience:** Advanced knowledge of hardware, software, and networking. Proficient in Windows, MS Office suites, data processing, and assisting others with technical concepts.

HONOURS & AWARDS

- Junior Orator (1998) - Best junior orator at Langenhoven Gimnasium.
- School Paper Editor (1999-2001) - Langenhoven Gimnasium.
- Media24 Educational Editorial Course (2001) - Selected as one of 25 students countrywide.
- De Beers English Olympiad (2001) - Obtained a silver award.
- SA Taalbond Bilingual Language Exam (2001) - Received certificate for participation in the senior category.
- RCL (Representative Council of Learners) (2001) - Langenhoven Gimnasium.
- Golden Key Academic Society (2003) - Lifetime membership for top 10% academic achievement in first year.
- Ceifel Training Camp, Korea (2010) - Certificate of Completion for 2010 Training for Native English Teachers.

CHARACTER REFERENCES

Prof Gustav Butler

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Prof Johanita Kirsten

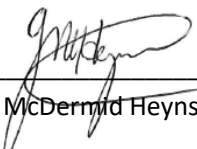
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DECLARATION

I hereby declare that the above-mentioned information is true and accurate. I have no objection if your office corresponds with any of the references regarding my character as well as my work ethics and ability.



Jacques McDermid Heyns